done. Luckily, AWS Systems Manager (SSM) Patch Manager is a good choice to make patching more robust and stable.

The AWS Systems Manager provides a toolbox that includes a core set of features bundled into capabilities. Patch Manager is one such capability. The following core SSM features are bundled together in the Patch Manager, as figure 5.2 shows:

- *Agent*—Preinstalled and autostarted on Amazon Linux 2 (also powers the Session Manager).
- *Document*—Think of a document as a script on steroids. We use a prebuild document named `AWS-RunPatchBaseline` to install patches.
- *Run Command*—Executes a document on an EC2 instance.
- *Association*—Sends commands (via Run Command) to EC2 instances on a schedule or during startup (bundled into the capability named State Manager).
- *Maintenance Window*—Sends commands (via Run Command) to EC2 instances on a schedule during a time window.
- *Patch baseline*—Set of rules to approve patches for installation based on classification and severity. Luckily, AWS provides predefined patch baselines for various operating systems including Amazon Linux 2. The predefined patch baseline for Amazon Linux 2 approves all security patches that have a severity level of critical or important and all bug fixes. A seven-day waiting period exists after the release of a patch before approval.